

THE BEST TABLETS

Under ₹ 30,000

This article lists the important purchase parameters along with some budget-friendly options for tablets, that will help you choose the right one for your own use.

From students to professionals, tablets are a popular option when it comes to daily work or other such activities as reading, gaming, drawing, voice-calling, browsing, streaming, etc. Tablets are lightweight and portable, hence easier to use than laptops or PCs. These usually have a bigger screen size than smartphones. To accommodate the needs of every user, tablets come both as convertible tablet PCs as well as standalone options.

A convertible tablet PC can act as a laptop when a detachable keyboard is used with it—it also provides the additional capability of touch. It works with a stylus, too.

Not required for heavy tasks, a standalone tablet, on the other hand, is much more portable and cheaper. It has an interface like a smartphone with the operating system (OS) being mostly Android or iOS.

Such functionalities have increased the demand for tablets in the market.

Purchase parameters

Based on the purpose of buying a tablet, it becomes easy to choose the right one once you are clear about the features. Some of these features are discussed next.

Display: Screen size and resolution are necessary to understand how many pixels will be present in one square inch. The higher the pixels per square inch, the better the display quality. High-definition (HD) resolution means 1280x720 pixels, full HD

means 1920x1080 pixels and quad HD means 2560x1440 pixels. On average, standalone tablets have a display size of 20.3cm to 26.7cm (8 inches to 10.5 inches). As in convertible tablet PCs, a large screen size is better for work.

Build: Portability and durability are important, especially for travellers. Most tablets have metallic bodies. Smaller and lightweight ones are easy to carry around.

Battery: mAh (milli-ampere hour) is the unit of electric charge, which is usually mentioned in battery specifications. The larger the mAh, the higher the battery capacity. To power a device for a longer time for multitasking activities that involve intensive tasks, a higher mAh is required. Besides, one should charge the battery with a charger that has the same current capacity to ensure longer life of the battery.

Storage: While three to four gigabytes (3GB to 4GB) of RAM suffices the purpose of tablets, high internal storage (ROM) is also essential for tasks like storing movies. Inbuilt storage is usually around 16GB to 32GB, but many tablets come with the option to expand storage to as high as 512GB.

Processor: The processor is the most important component for good performance of tablets, as it includes both CPU and GPU. Just like laptops, Windows tablets generally use Intel processors, but their counterparts mostly contain the ones found in smartphones such as Qualcomm's Snapdragon processor.

Clock speed of 1GHz means that one billion instructions can be processed in one second. The higher the clock speed, the better the performance.

Operating system: Convertible tablet PCs mainly use Microsoft Windows OS for providing two-in-one capabilities. Other tablets use Apple iOS and Google's Android OS. The option to update the OS is usually available manually. As the tablets get older, updates are no longer provided. Released in 2018, Android 9 Pie is the latest Android OS.

Security: Many tablets come with features like touch ID and face scan for safety purposes. Parental control, screen time limit feature, etc, are other options available to users.

Connectivity: For functions such as browsing, voice-calling and streaming videos, network connectivity is required. Technologies supported by tablets are Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, Hotspot and 4G. Along with 2.4GHz spectrum, 5GHz spectrum is also supported in many tablets besides the Wi-Fi connectivity. To use 4G wireless (cellular) technology, single or dual SIM slots are available to insert the SIM, but the data plan needs to be bought separately.

Camera: When it comes to the rear camera, resolution lies in the range of five to ten megapixels. The front camera has a lower resolution than the primary one. Although smartphones are the preferred choice for cameras, tablets still give the option to capture images and share them.